

at this point most probably your beeping pattern has changed.

- a. Power on the computer or restart it if it's already on.
 - b. Listen very carefully to the beeps that are being emitted by a small speaker on your motherboard [You don't need external speakers]
 - c. You can restart your computer a few times if you couldn't hear it properly the first time, it's unlikely that by merely restarting a few times you'll make your issue far worse. Of course refrain from doing this if any burning smell or smoke is at play.
 - d. Note down the exact beep pattern, the points to note are if it was a short beep or long beep, and how often was it repeated.
 - e. Now Google for the beep codes of your respective motherboard/BIOS manufacturer. For example for AWARD BIOS (one of the most common one), you can find the beep code listing at <http://dgit.in/GRdv9H> You'll notice that you can find a great deal of information and specific information on your issue.
4. Often in these scenarios, one typical issue can be solved by resetting the RAM. It's simple to do even on laptops and nearly all manufactures, except Apple. You'll have a simple panel at the back which can be removed to access the RAM. You don't need any specialized tools, but be sure to keep one barefoot on the ground while handling the RAM to prevent damage by static discharge.

Turns on but doesn't start booting into OS

This issue is typically encountered where either your Master Boot Record (which tells what to load in BootLoader, refer to BOX 2) is broken or your Boot Loader is broken. This arises in two typical scenarios. One when you're trying to install Windows after installing Linux, and then you find yourself with no way to enter Linux or when you install Linux after installing Windows, and then deleted the Linux partition. Or if you're simply seeing the dreaded "BootMgr is missing" error, read on.

HOW DOES A PC BOOT?

It is important to understand how your computer starts and what the words BIOS and POST mean. A typical BIOS screen is where you can change some system critical settings. The BIOS, which stands for Basic Input/Output System is already present in the computer and is the first code run by it when switched on. This outputs the first thing you see on your monitor. BIOS now calls the POST, which stands for Power-On Self-Test. POST is responsible for the identification and initialization of system devices such as the CPU, RAM, video display card, IO devices etc. The BIOS then locates the "Boot Loader" software stored on an attached storage medium or over the network (designated as a 'boot device', and the priority of lookup from HDD, PenDrive, CD-ROM, Network can be changed by the User). The Boot Loader then typically loads the designated (or selected in case of multiple OS) Operating System.

1. You want only Windows:
 - a. For Windows XP, insert your disk. Press 'R' to enter the recovery console. When you reach the command prompt simply enter "fixmbr" let the process finish, reboot the system, remove the disk and voilà it'll start working.
 - b. For Windows 7/ Vista, insert your setup/recovery disk. After that, click next through the usual options, select "Repair your computer". It will then list out your installed Operating System, select the correct one. Click next and from the following menu for choosing a recovery tool, select "Startup Repair". Let the process finish, reboot your system and remove your disk. You can also accomplish the same by choosing the command prompt option and simply typing "bootrec /fixboot"
 - c. In case you don't have a setup or recovery disk, or your system doesn't have CD drive, then take out your Linux Live Pen Drive [Refer TOOL BOX]. Boot into linux. Open a Terminal session by Applications > Accessories > Terminal and type in the following


```
"sudo apt-get install ms-sys"
```

 Followed by:


```
"sudo fdisk -l"
```

 Look for something like /dev/sda1 XYZXYZ NTFS at the end of the output and then type:


```
"sudo ms-sys -m /dev/sda"
```

 Note there is no 'l' in the above command, it would be

between "sda" or "hda" or "sdb" depending on your system Reboot the machine, remove your pen drive and you're done.

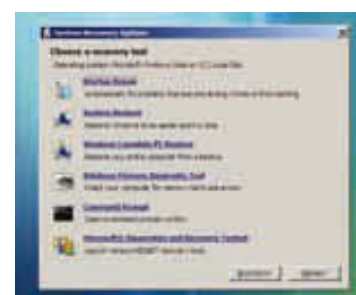
2. You want both Linux and Windows:
 - a. Follow step c from the previous set, but instead type this:


```
"sudo fdisk -l"
```

 Figure out the device where linux is installed from "sda"/"hda"/"sdb" And then type


```
"sudo grub-install /dev/XXX"
```

 Where XXX is the above mentioned device name. Reboot your system.
 - b. If you're looking for a graphical way, refer to this guide: <http://dgit.in/helpada>



System restore

Starts booting but shuts down

1. Keep pressing F8 key while the system boots, to access the startup menu and see if Windows will boot into Safe Mode. If you're able to get into Windows, the problem is most likely with your graphics card drivers, junk applications, or perhaps some spyware applications. Try remembering your recent changes and revert them from here.